



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Maynard High School teacher Jean LaBelle-Pierce spoke with student Sierra Nauseda about her class work.

A diploma and something more

By requiring real-life skills, some schools may offer a model to replace MCAS

By Christopher Huffaker
GLOBE STAFF

In Jean LaBelle-Pierce's "senior project" class at Maynard High School on a recent day, one student was researching the UN's response to war crimes in Syria; another, the ethics of breeding animals; a third, pediatric patient recovery. A day before, local community members in a variety of careers held mock job interviews for students. A day later, LaBelle-Pierce taught the students about saving for retirement.

"I'm learning more than I thought I would," said Rowan Casañas, a student in LaBelle-

Pierce's class working on a research paper about safety and stress on college campuses.

In Maynard, this daily class has been a graduation requirement for the past few years.

As Massachusetts scrambles to craft new statewide graduation standards to replace the MCAS, programs like Maynard's will almost certainly be a core component, inspired by a national movement in education toward requiring real-world skills. Advocates argue that projects give students the opportunity to work creatively, practice communication, and solve concrete problems, but experimentation in some districts and other states suggests creat-

ing a consistent standard for student work across communities will take substantial effort.

On Monday, Governor Maura Healey released a broad outline for new graduation requirements, including both locally graded projects and mandatory, state-graded tests. Business leaders and some educators applauded the approach, arguing that testing would ensure all students meet uniformly high standards.

The Massachusetts Teachers Association, which led the charge to abolish the MCAS re-

QUIREMENT, Page A6

More in area at risk as ICE steps up arrests

By Scooty Nickerson
GLOBE STAFF

Arrests by immigration authorities in New England nearly tripled in September from the previous month, driven by a major surge in enforcement known as "Patriot 2.0."

With more than 1,500 arrests, September marked the second-highest monthly tally in New England, after May, since President Trump took office for the second time.

The new data are from US Immigration and Customs Enforcement as shared publicly by the Deportation Data Project, a University of California Berkeley-based nonprofit.

More than half of people arrested in September had not been convicted of or charged with crimes.

"Folks are at risk of arrest by ICE not just because they are finishing up serving criminal sentences, but because they are dropping their kids off at school, or taking the bus to work," Sarah Sherman-Stokes of the Immigrants' Rights and Human Trafficking Program at Boston University said.

She and others say the spike has only intensified fears in immigrant communities across the region that they might be next.

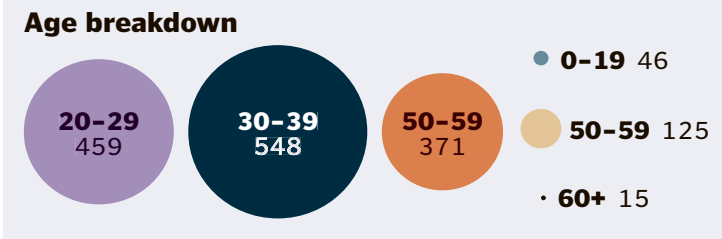
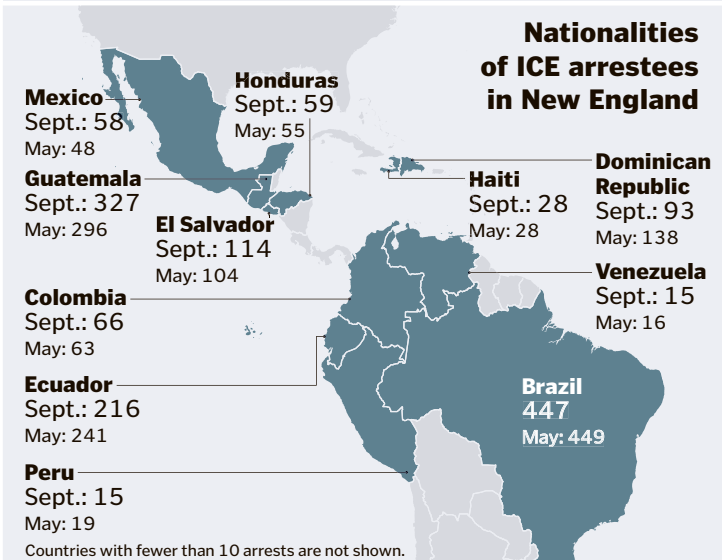
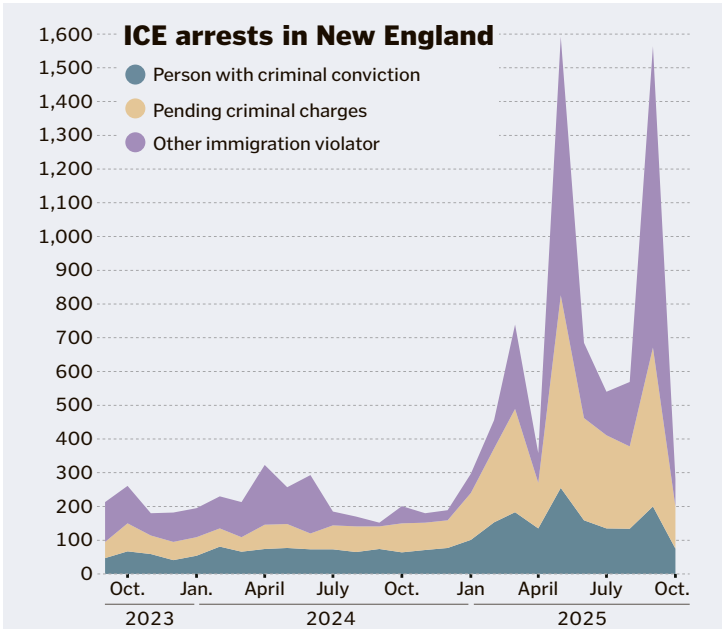
"There's a degree of terror in communities across New England that is somewhat unprecedented," she said.

Among countries of origin, the largest number came from Brazil: 447 arrested in September. Second were people from Guatemala, followed by Ecuador.

Most of those arrested in September were between the ages of 20 and 39, although there were some striking outliers. The youngest was born in 2023, while the oldest was born in 1954.

"All bets are off," Sherman-Stokes said. "ICE is now pervasive."

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SOURCE: ICE via Deportation Data Project

SCOOTY NICKERSON/GLOBE STAFF

Don't be fooled by cold days in N.E.

Region one of fastest warming in the world

By Sabrina Shankman
GLOBE STAFF

Remember winters of saving newly shoveled parking spaces with beach chairs, or layering up to play pond hockey in the bitter cold? Well, despite this week's burst of frigid weather in New England, those days are becoming increasingly rare, according to a new study.

New England is among the fastest warming regions in the entire world, not just in the United States, having experienced more than 4.5 degrees Fahrenheit (2.5 degrees Celsius) warming between 1900 and 2024.

Nowhere is that warming showing up more than during New England winters, when temperatures are rising twice as fast as in other seasons, bringing significant losses in snow cover, according to the study published Thursday in the journal Climate.

"We are in this transition from a stable climate to an unstable climate, and we really need to prepare for it,"

WINTER, Page A7

Military leaders show video of boat

Democrats, Republicans draw different conclusions

By Megan Mineiro, Julian E. Barnes, and Dave Philipps
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — Top military officers on Thursday showed senior members of Congress a video of a Sept. 2 attack on a boat suspected of carrying drugs, including a follow-up strike that has been at the center of a growing debate over the Trump administration's lethal mission.

General Dan Caine, the chair of the Joint Chiefs of Staff, and Admiral Frank M. Bradley, a top Special Operations commander who oversaw the attack, met with members of Congress to discuss the operation and defend the decision to launch a second strike that killed survivors of the first missile.

The military officers briefed the Republican chairs and senior Democrats on the House and Senate Armed Services and Intelligence Committees, as well as defense appropriators, all behind closed doors.

Lawmakers briefed by Bradley said the admiral denied that he was given any order, written or oral, to "kill them all" or "grant no quarter," rejecting public reports that Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth had directly ordered the follow-up strike to kill the survivors.

But Republicans and Democrats left the closed-door meetings drawing starkly different conclusions after watching the unedited video of the initial strike on the boat and the follow-up that killed the survivors and sank the boat.

STRIKES, Page A4



ANNA MONEYSMAKER/GETTY IMAGES

Admiral Frank M. Bradley reportedly denied that he was given any order to "kill them all" or "grant no quarter."

CDC panel may drop support of hepatitis B vaccine

But recommendation will stand in Mass.

By Jason Laughlin
GLOBE STAFF

Since Donald Trump's election, Massachusetts' public health director, Dr. Robbie Goldstein, has been preparing for a situation that once seemed unimaginable: a presidential administration limiting access to life-saving vaccines for millions of Americans.

That scenario is now a possibility, Goldstein said. On Friday, an influential vaccine advisory panel could end a 34-year national consensus on the importance of vaccinating newborns against the liver infection hepatitis B.

If the panel, which advises the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, reverses the longstanding recommendation that all infants be immunized at birth, it would be the most significant policy change yet under Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr., undoing an inoculation strategy credited with virtually eliminating the illness among infants.

And that may be only the first step: The panel is also expected to reconsider the entire vaccine schedule for children, according to the latest agenda for Friday's meeting.

The panel was considering multiple options for changing the administration of hepatitis B shots Thursday but delayed a vote to Friday af-

HEPATITIS B, Page A6

The Supreme Court cleared the way for Texas lawmakers to use redrawn congressional maps favoring Republicans in the 2026 midterms. **A5.**

Dr. Ashish K. Jha, who became a household name during the pandemic, is leaving his post as the dean of the Brown University School of Public Health at the end of the year. **B1.**

President Vladimir Putin said that parts of the US peace plan are unacceptable and that Russia would take Ukrainian land through military force or other means. **A3.**

Many stars have taken a crack at playing Ebenezer Scrooge over the years, but these five stand out, writes Odie Henderson. **G1.**



Hey, bitter better

Friday: Very cold to start. High 25-30. Low 23-28.

Saturday: More seasonable. High 36-41. Low 28-33.

Weather and Comics, G6-7.

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